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Those who fear death because they fear the end of their existence are unlikely to be consoled by Lucretius' first argument.

Here is a natural response to the first premise: 'Yes, it is true that I will have no experiences after I die. But just that fact is part of what makes death so horrible. What is bad about death is that after death I will not exist — and my non-existence is the worst thing that can happen to me.'

One can think of Luncratius' second argument as a reply to this objection.

1. The only things I should fear are experiences which I undergo.
2. When I am dead, I undergo no experiences.

C. I should not fear death. (1,2)

THE LUCRETIAN ARGUMENT

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